

Unit 10 At Sea – Changing the Watch

Read & Listen

Exercise 1

The Marina has successfully completed her loading and unloading in the Port of Antwerp. The weather is fine and the Marina **<is underway>** towards Scandinavia. She is **<passing along>** Öresund, with its great traffic density. Captain James is conning the ship. Mr Gray, **< the helmsman>**, is carrying out the orders.

- **<Full speed>**. Steer 150 degrees, orders Captain James.
- Steer 150 degrees, repeats Gray, the helmsman.

A few seconds later when the compass card settles on the mark, Gray says:

“<Steering one-five-zero degrees, sir>”.

- **<Port 10 degrees>**.
- **<Port 10>**, sir, repeats Gray.
- **<Ease to five>**, says the Captain and Gray brings the wheel back.
- Midships.
- Midships.
- **<Steer one-three-zero>** degrees.
- **<Steering one-three-zero>** degrees, answers Gray as the heading steadies.

Exercise 2

It is close to 12 o'clock and time to hand over the watch to the Second Mate Timo Ranta. He enters the bridge a few minutes early and is greeted by the Captain.

- Good morning Timo, says Captain James. **<Ready to take over>?**
- I am indeed. Any special problems?

- Well, we are in an area of high traffic density. The Öresund strait is not one of my favourites. It can be rather tricky. There is a great deal of <crossing traffic> and there seems to be extremely heavy traffic at the moment.
- Yes, that sounds familiar, I've been in these waters before.
- As you can see from the display our position is 56° 23' North and 012° 01.0' East, course 131 degrees speed 17 knots, draught <7.0 metres/7.0 m/7.0 meters>.
- <Passenger ferry> is crossing from port side. The vessel should give way.
- <Roro vessel on our port bow>, 1 mile ahead of us is on the same course. The bearing to the vessel is constant. Call me if a vessel passes with a <CPA> of less than 1 mile, and keep a <0.5 mile CPA> for smaller boats all according to the <standing orders>. As you know there is a great number of fishing vessels in the area. So <keep a sharp lookout> – weather conditions seem to be changing. The wind is <southwest> 7 metres/second but visibility is expected to decrease, due to fog. The next weather report will be at 1200 UTC. You may have to reduce speed.
- Ok, understood.

Exercise 3

To navigate safely from one place to another, the ship's position must be **1. recorded** on charts. The positions must be checked very often. This can be done in different ways.

In the old days, when no land was in sight, one took observations of the sun, moon, and stars with a sextant and then **2. worked out** the position. Satellite navigational equipment, the GPS, is today the most **3. accurate** and most important aid to navigation. Radar is used both on ships and ashore. Because the picture on the radar **4. screen** must not be **5. disturbed** by the ship's masts, funnels, derricks, etc. the radar scanner is usually **6. installed** very high.

1. to make a note of
2. calculated
3. precise
4. display
5. be upset by
6. set up

Exercise 4

In coastal areas it is possible to **1. take bearings** of the land or of seamarks **2. by visual means** or by radar.

Today many ships have an electronic chart which shows the ship's position and route. Information on the route is fed into the ship's integrated navigational system and the ship can be switched from manual to automatic steering, the so-called auto-pilot.

If you need to find out how deep the water is, you can **3. take soundings** by use of the **4. echo-sounder**, or **4. a sonar**. If it is cloudy, no land can be sighted, and all other navigational aids are **5. out of function**, the position may still be calculated by dead reckoning.

- 1. positioning by aid of a fixed point**
- 2. by seeing**
- 3. to measure water depth**
- 4. devices used for taking soundings**
- 5. not working**

Exercise 5

1. If you want to find how deep the water is you have to take **<soundings>**.
2. This can be done by an **<echo sounder>** or **<sonar>**.
3. The opposite of automatic steering or use of the auto-pilot is **<manual>** steering.
4. When the vessel's stability is good, it is on an **<even keel>**.
5. Sea Area 1 requires **<short>** range radio services.
6. Sea Area A2 requires **<medium>** range radio services.
7. Sea Areas A3 and A4 require **<long>** range alerting radio services.
8. In the Rules of the Road an expression for keeping course and speed is to **<stand on>**.
9. To let another ship pass is to **<give way>**.
10. To work out a ship's position from the course steered and the speed through water is called **<dead reckoning>**.

Exercise 6

AIS is short for <**Automatic Identification System**>.

NBDP is short for <**Narrow Band Direct Printing**>.

DSC is short for <**Digital Selective Calling**>.

Mf is short for <**Medium frequency**>.

Hf is short for <**High frequency**>.

MHz is short for <**Megahertz**>.

GPS is short for <**Global Positioning System**>

EPIRB is short for <**Emergency Position Indicating**> Radio Beacon.

<**Satnav**> messages is short for <satellite navigational > messages.

GMDSS is short for <**Global Maritime Distress**> and Safety system.

IMO is short for <**International Maritime Organization**>.

ETA is short for <**Estimated**> Time of Arrival.

VHF is short for <**Very High Frequency**>.

<**SAR**> is short for Search and Rescue.

VTs is short for <**Vessel Traffic Services**>.

CPA is short for <**Closest Point of Approach**>.